

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAikulAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – PR3 DEEP WATER

Marks :

Name :

Duration :

Exam No. :

1. Extract-Based Comprehension Questions with Answers

Passage 1:

"It had happened when I was ten or eleven years old. I had decided to learn to swim. There was a pool at the YMCA in Yakima that offered exactly the opportunity. The Yakima River was treacherous. Mother continually warned against it and kept fresh in my mind the details of each drowning in the river."

Questions:

1. **MCQ:** Why did the narrator choose the YMCA pool over the Yakima River? A) The pool was safer than the river B) The pool was closer to his home C) The river was too shallow D) The river was too crowded
2. **MCQ:** What was the narrator's mother's concern about the Yakima River? A) It was too cold for swimming B) It was treacherous and dangerous C) It was too far from their home D) It was polluted
3. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The narrator's mother warned him against swimming in the Yakima River. **Reason (R):** The Yakima River was known for its dangerous currents and frequent drownings. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
4. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The narrator was determined to learn swimming despite his fears. **Reason (R):** He wanted to overcome his fear of water and enjoy swimming. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
5. **Choose the Words:** What does the word "**treacherous**" mean in the context of the passage? A) Safe and calm B) Dangerous and unpredictable C) Shallow and clear D) Deep and peaceful

Answers:

1. **A**
2. **B**
3. **A**
4. **A**
5. **B**

Passage 2:

"I had an aversion to the water when I was in it. This started when I was three or four years old and my father took me to the beach in California. He and I stood together in the surf. The waves knocked me down and swept over me. I was buried in water. My breath was gone. I was frightened. Father laughed, but there was terror in my heart at the overpowering force of the waves."

Questions:

1. **MCQ:** What caused the narrator's initial fear of water? A) He fell into a pool B) He was knocked down by waves at the beach C) He saw someone drown D) He was pushed into the water by his father
2. **MCQ:** How did the narrator's father react to the incident at the beach? A) He was concerned and helped immediately B) He laughed, unaware of the narrator's fear C) He scolded the narrator for being scared D) He ignored the situation
3. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The narrator developed a fear of water at a young age. **Reason (R):** He had a traumatic experience with waves at the beach. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
4. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The narrator's father was supportive during the incident. **Reason (R):** He laughed to encourage the narrator to face his fears. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
5. **Choose the Words:** What does the phrase "**overpowering force of the waves**" suggest? A) The waves were gentle and calming B) The waves were strong and frightening C) The waves were shallow and harmless D) The waves were predictable and safe

Answers:

1. **B**
2. **B**
3. **A**
4. **D**
5. **B**

Passage 3:

"At last I felt released—free to walk the trails and climb the peaks and to brush aside fear. The experience had a deep meaning for me, as only those who have known stark terror and

conquered it can appreciate. In death there is peace. There is terror only in the fear of death, as Roosevelt knew when he said, 'All we have to fear is fear itself.'"

Questions:

1. **MCQ:** What did the narrator feel after overcoming his fear of water? A) Confused and anxious B) Free and confident C) Sad and regretful D) Indifferent and detached
2. **MCQ:** What does the narrator mean by "In death there is peace"? A) Death is terrifying B) Death is peaceful compared to the fear of it C) Death is inevitable and painful D) Death is a punishment
3. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The narrator felt liberated after conquering his fear. **Reason (R):** He realized that fear is more terrifying than the actual experience. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
4. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The narrator quotes Roosevelt to emphasize his point. **Reason (R):** Roosevelt's words highlight the irrational nature of fear. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
5. **Choose the Words:** What does the phrase "**brush aside fear**" mean? A) To ignore fear completely B) To confront and overcome fear C) To avoid fearful situations D) To accept fear as part of life

Answers:

1. **B**
2. **B**
3. **A**
4. **A**
5. **B**

Passage 4:

"The next time I went to the pool, my terror returned. I tried to fight it. The instructor tied a belt around me, held one end, and let me go into the water. I was able to paddle with confidence under his guidance, but the fear remained. Gradually, after repeated practice, I overcame my fear and learned to swim."

Questions:

1. **MCQ:** How did the narrator initially feel when he returned to the pool? A) Confident and fearless B) Terrified but determined C) Excited about swimming D) Indifferent to his fears
2. **MCQ:** How did the instructor help the narrator overcome his fear? A) He forced him to swim alone B) He tied a belt to support him in the water C) He left him to learn without guidance D) He made him jump into deep water immediately
3. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The narrator overcame his fear through repeated practice. **Reason (R):** He realized that the fear of drowning was only psychological, not physical. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
4. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The instructor played a crucial role in helping the narrator regain confidence. **Reason (R):** Proper training and guidance can help individuals overcome personal fears. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
5. **Choose the Words:** What does "gradually, after repeated practice" imply in this passage? A) Learning was quick and effortless B) Progress took time and patience C) Fear disappeared instantly D) Swimming was never learned properly

Answers:

1. **B**
2. **B**
3. **A**
4. **A**
5. **B**

Passage 5:

"At last I felt liberated. Swimming across the lake proved that I had conquered my fear completely. I had lived with that terror for years, but now I could swim without any hesitation. It was a moment of triumph—a victory over my mind that had long been captive to irrational fear."

Questions:

1. **MCQ:** What event confirmed the narrator's victory over fear? A) Jumping into a pool B) Swimming across a lake C) Learning about water safety D) Avoiding deep water
2. **MCQ:** What emotion does the narrator associate with overcoming fear? A) Joy and triumph B) Confusion and doubt C) Regret and sorrow D) Anger and frustration

3. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The narrator realized his fear had been irrational. **Reason (R):** He understood that fear is only a mental barrier that can be overcome through persistence. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
4. **Assertion-Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The narrator's experience teaches an important life lesson. **Reason (R):** Overcoming fear requires courage, discipline, and perseverance. A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C) A is true, but R is false. D) A is false, but R is true.
5. **Choose the Words:** What does "**captive to irrational fear**" mean in this passage? A) Free from any fear B) Controlled by an unnecessary fear C) Strong and fearless D) Unable to feel emotions

Answers:

1. **B**
2. **A**
3. **A**
4. **A**
- 5.

☐ 2-Mark Short Answer Questions

1. What was the 'misadventure' that Douglas refers to? Answer: Douglas was pushed into the deep end of the YMCA pool by a big boy, which nearly drowned him and instilled a deep fear of water. **Marking Scheme:** 1 mark for identifying the incident, 1 mark for explaining its impact.

2. Why did Douglas hire an instructor? Answer: To overcome his fear of water and learn swimming with confidence after the traumatic incident at the YMCA pool. **Marking Scheme:** 1 mark for mentioning the instructor, 1 mark for purpose.

☐ Story-Based Questions

1. How does William Douglas's experience at the YMCA pool shape his later life? Answer: The experience left him with a chronic fear of water, but overcoming it made him resilient and gave him courage to face other life challenges.

2. What does the title "Deep Water" signify in the context of the story? Answer: It symbolizes both the literal danger of drowning and the metaphorical depth of fear that Douglas had to conquer.

☐ Value-Based Questions

1. What does the narrative teach us about overcoming fear? Answer: It emphasizes that fear is psychological and can be defeated through persistence, courage, and professional help.

2. How does the story highlight the importance of determination and mental strength? Answer: Douglas's rigorous efforts to unlearn fear and his refusal to give up underscore the triumph of determination over weakness.

☐ Competency-Based Questions

1. If you were in Douglas's position, how would you handle such a phobia today? Answer: I would seek therapy or professional guidance, practice exposure gradually, and develop mental resilience through consistent effort. **Skill Assessed:** Critical thinking and application in a real-life context.

2. How can Douglas's story inspire today's youth dealing with anxiety or trauma? Answer: It shows that facing one's fears head-on and not letting past trauma define you is key to personal growth and confidence. **Skill Assessed:** Empathy and reflective thinking.

☐ Character-Based Questions

1. Describe the character of William Douglas based on this prose. Answer: Douglas is introspective, determined, and resilient. His courage to overcome a deep-seated fear shows strength of character. **Marking Scheme:** 1 mark for traits, 1 mark for textual reference or incident.

2. What qualities helped Douglas overcome his fear of water? Answer: His patience, persistence, self-awareness, and willingness to seek help were crucial to his victory over fear. **Marking Scheme:** 1 mark for traits, 1 mark for explanation.

Long Question and Answer (Sub topics are provided for your understanding only. You need not use them in your answers)

1. Theme-Based Question

Q: Discuss the central theme of fear and its triumph in "Deep Water."

Answer: Introduction: The central theme of William Douglas's *Deep Water* revolves around fear—how it originates, how it grows, and how it can ultimately be conquered with determination.

Paragraph 1: Douglas recounts a personal incident of near-drowning at the YMCA pool, which triggers a lifelong fear of water. He reflects on how fear is not just a physical reaction but a psychological force that can dominate one's life.

Paragraph 2: With the guidance of a swimming instructor and disciplined effort, Douglas gradually overcomes his fear. His journey illustrates that facing fear head-on and refusing to give in is the key to reclaiming freedom and peace.

Conclusion: *Deep Water* is a powerful testimony to the human spirit's ability to triumph over fear, inspiring readers to confront their own inner struggles with courage.

2. Value-Based Question

Q: What life lesson does Douglas impart through his experience in “Deep Water”?

Answer: Introduction: William Douglas's autobiographical account in *Deep Water* offers an essential life lesson: fear can be defeated if faced with persistence and willpower.

Paragraph 1: After his frightening experience at the YMCA pool, Douglas could have chosen to avoid water forever. However, he resolved to overcome the fear rather than let it define him. His decision marked the beginning of a transformative journey.

Paragraph 2: Douglas's narrative teaches us that personal challenges, no matter how intense, can be overcome through consistent effort and self-belief. His story emphasizes patience, resilience, and the courage to reclaim control over one's fears.

Conclusion: Ultimately, Douglas's experience serves as a motivational guide for those struggling with internal fears and shows that self-conquest leads to true liberation.

3. Article-Based Question

Q: Write an article on “The Role of Willpower in Overcoming Fear,” using Douglas's life as an example.

Answer: Introduction: Fear is a universal human experience, but it is our willpower that determines whether it controls us or we control it. William Douglas's experience in *Deep Water* is a testament to this truth.

Paragraph 1: A childhood incident at the YMCA pool left Douglas with an intense fear of water. Rather than surrender to it, he chose to confront it by taking swimming lessons and gradually rebuilding confidence.

Paragraph 2: Douglas's victory was not immediate—it was marked by setbacks and emotional turmoil. Yet, his willpower and perseverance led him to master swimming and erase the trauma from his mind.

Conclusion: Douglas's story reminds us that willpower is the strongest weapon against fear. When paired with action, it can transform vulnerability into strength.

4. Speech-Based Question

Q: Prepare a motivational speech on “Courage Over Fear,” inspired by Douglas's experience.

Answer: Introduction: Good morning everyone! Today, I want to share a story that redefines bravery—the journey of William Douglas in *Deep Water*, which taught the world the value of courage over fear.

Paragraph 1: Douglas nearly drowned as a child, and the incident left him terrified of water. But instead of running from that fear, he bravely chose to face it. With help and training, he slowly chipped away at the anxiety that had taken hold.

Paragraph 2: His story proves that courage is not about never feeling afraid—it's about moving forward in spite of fear. Every lap he swam was a step closer to freedom and a triumph of will over weakness.

Conclusion: Let us all take inspiration from Douglas. Whether your fear is of failing, speaking, or swimming—face it. Because the moment you do, fear begins to lose its power.

5. Story-Based Question

Q: Narrate an incident from your own life that mirrors Douglas's struggle with fear.

Answer: Introduction: Like William Douglas, I too once battled a fear that held me back—mine was the fear of public speaking.

Paragraph 1: My first classroom presentation was a disaster—I stuttered, forgot my lines, and faced laughter. Humiliated, I avoided all public speaking opportunities. But stories like Douglas's inspired me to change.

Paragraph 2: I joined a drama club and began speaking in small groups. Over time, the tremors lessened, and my confidence grew. That first moment of applause gave me the same feeling Douglas describes—liberation.

Conclusion: Today, I can speak to an audience without fear. Like Douglas, I learned that facing our fears is the first step to overcoming them.

6. Author's Point of View-Based Question

Q: How does William Douglas use personal narration to make his account more impactful?

Answer: Introduction: William Douglas's use of first-person narration in *Deep Water* makes his emotional journey more vivid and impactful.

Paragraph 1: By sharing his inner thoughts and physical sensations, Douglas allows readers to experience his fear and helplessness during the drowning incident. This approach fosters empathy and deep engagement.

Paragraph 2: His reflective tone and detailed recollection of events add psychological depth to the story. Readers understand not just what happened, but how it shaped him as a person.

Conclusion: The personal narration transforms the story from a simple incident to a universal lesson, making Douglas's triumph over fear both relatable and inspirational.

7. Diary Entry-Based Question

Q: Write a diary entry from Douglas's perspective on the day he overcomes his fear.

Answer: Introduction: [Diary Entry – Date: The day after my final swim test]

Paragraph 1: Dear Diary, Today, I swam across the lake—and for the first time, I wasn't afraid. I felt the water move around me, but it no longer held the power to control me.

Paragraph 2: There was no panic, only peace. I waited for fear, but it never came. I smiled the entire way. I've reclaimed the part of myself I lost years ago.

Conclusion: I've done it. I'm free now—not just from water, but from the fear that haunted me. And with that freedom comes strength I never knew I had.